



METHODOLOGY

How The Ranking Was Done

The rankings have been derived using district-level data from Indicus District Development Database. For instance, for socio-economic variables, data is available for female literacy, primary to upper primary school transition, poverty ratio (deriving from work done by Amaresh Dubey), marginal workers, immunisation of children and

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weight for age. With equal weightage, this enables one to construct a socio-economic index for each district. Similarly, it is also possible to construct a physical infrastructure index. Data is available on household electrification, households with telephones and areas connected by pucca roads. With equal weights, one can now construct a composite index. For each district, one has a socio-economic index and a physical infrastructure index. The next step is to map districts with parliamentary constituencies. If this isn't available and requires one to

determine what percentage of a constituency's population is located in which district. If this is known, weighted averages of district values can be used to obtain estimates for constituencies.

Most data for this was available from the Delimitation Commission, which itself used Census 2001. However, it wasn't available for Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Delhi, Jammu and Kashmir and Manipur. For these states, we used data from total valid votes cast in 2004 elections, available from the Election Commission, to work out shares. It was then standardised by taking the value of the variable minus its minimum value in the numerator and the maximum value of the variable minus its minimum value in the denominator. The standardised values were then aggregated to obtain a socio-economic index and a physical infrastructure index. If the ranking of constituencies show surprises compared with a priori expectations, that's because of imperfect recognition that some constituencies are assumed to be urban, though they possess significant rural segments. Visakhapatnam is a case in point. The gap between all the Mumbai constituencies and Koraput-Kalahandi or Araria-Valmiki Nagar is so wide that it should trigger national political concern. The rankings offer the political class facts that they may want to factor in their new manifestoes.

by Bibek Debroy
and Laveesh Bhandari

member of the Nehru-Gandhi parivar in eight of 14 general elections, ranks 507 on the socio-economic development and 464 for access to infrastructure. It is not just prime ministers. Even though Railway Minister Lalu Prasad, who represents Chapra (now Saran), has been the chief minister twice, his constituency ranks 407. Rural Development Minister Raghuvansh Prasad Singh is spearheading one of the biggest rural spend programmes ever in independent India. His constituency Vaishali which has elected him four times ranks 483.

If it is not lack of clout, it isn't lack of

MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

SONIA GANDHI RANK
CHAIRPERSON, UPA Socio-economic Infrastructure

RAE BARELI, 507 | 464
UTTAR PRADESH

The seat has been represented eight times by the first family of Indian politics. Will conquering Uttar Pradesh politically help?

MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

RAHUL GANDHI, RANK
GEN SECY, CONGRESS Socio-economic Infrastructure

AMETHI, 484 | 475
UTTAR PRADESH

Being represented by the Gandhis including Sanjay and Rajiv five times has made no impact on the constituency.